Animate Me

By Ruth Clampett

NATHAN: **(Pg 329)** There was once a boy, who longed to meet a special girl, yet he couldn't find her . . . that boy was me. Every girl I met was too hip, or mean, or not appealing . . . But one day, while I sat at a big company presentation, the most beautiful girl walked across the stage. *(As he speaks, Brooke enters, steps up to a podium, adjusts the microphone and begins to speak in silent pantomime)* She was smart, and funny, and charming . . . and beautiful.

BROOKE: **(Pg 157)** This is for the animation artists who put their hearts and souls into their work to create magic for us all. I'm honored to be a part of their world.

NATHAN: **(Pg 330)** And in that single moment, I fell in love.

INTRODUCTION

TOGETHER: *Animate Me by Ruth Clampett*

(Nathan is behind the counter at his 2nd job – A computer store. He's doodling when Brooke walks in)

BROOKE: **(Pg 10-15)** Hey, can you help me?

NATHAN: *(to audience)* Brooke Tobin, the woman of my dreams! *(coming around the counter a little too enthusiastically)* Sure, what can I help you with?

BROOKE: I need a cord thingy for my computer, and I'm not sure which one.

NATHAN: *(trying to sound like an authority)* Do you need a USB? *(Brooke looks perplexed. Nathan pushes his glasses up his nose)* The USB connection simplifies the process of connecting peripherals to the computer and offers much higher data transfer rates.

TIONAL USE ONLY

BROOKE: *(puts her hands on her hips and steps in to read his name tag)* Na-than? I don't speak tech geek. Can you give it to me straight? I just want a cord thingy so I can hook my old computer to my new one.

NATHAN: Uhhh, uhhh . . . this is probably what you need.

BROOKE: *(as they head to the register)* How much do I owe you?

NATHAN: Twelve forty-nine. *(to audience)* When she starts to set her money down I realize that my sketchbook's still open. *(Nathan hastily closes the book and holds it to his chest)*

BROOKE: Was that your drawing? Are you an artist?

NATHAN: Yeah . . . well, actually, I'm an animator. I work at Sketch Republic too. You're Brooke in development, right? *(To audience)* Good, that sounded cool . . . believable – like I don't dream about her all day.

BROOKE: Sorry I didn't recognize you. So what are you doing ***here***? Don't we pay you enough? Show me your work. *(Reaching for the sketchbook)* Are you good?

NATHAN: I'm really good and I'd love to show you my work, but this is just scribbling. *(Putting the book under the counter)* I want to show you the good stuff.

BROOKE: Okay, when you're ready, I'd be happy to look at your work. You know where to find me . . . . *(she turns to leave. Nathan watches her every move; she turns)* You know, Nathan, don't let the cool clothes fool you. Deep down I'm a fan-girl geek. *(she exits)*

NATHAN: *(to audience)* I am in love. **(pg 330)** [But] I'd never have a chance with [her]. [So] I took all my passion and dreams and put my energy into creating a character in [her] likeness. *(holds up a sketch for the audience to see)* And B-Girl was born – with sparkling eyes and flowing hair. Strong, brave and beautiful . . . just like Brooke.

********Scene Change********

(The next day at the office – Brooke is at her desk when Nathan shows up at her door with coffee in hand)

NATHAN: **(Pg 20 – 23)** I brought you coffee.

BROOKE: Thank you! *(She takes the coffee and sips.)* Mmmmm. If Arnauld saw you got me this, he would insist that you're flirting with me, but I think you're just a really nice guy. Which is it?

NATHAN: *(To audience)* My stomach flip-flops as I try to think how to respond. She smiles at me and lifts the cup. I've sketched her on the cup with a "B" on her chest like Superman's "S" and a cape flapping behind her.

BROOKE: How did you know I was a superhero? That's top-secret information.

NATHAN: Well, I'm one too. I sensed it with my super powers. *(To audience)* Wow, this is like a real conversation.

BROOKE: **(Pg 25-26)** Thanks so much for the coffee. It's been a crazy day. At least let me pay for it.

NATHAN: No. I've been taking a class on chivalry, so this is coursework. You're helping me out actually.

BROOKE: Really? What other classes are you taking?

NATHAN: Conversation skills. Can I practice with you?

BROOKE: Sure, I've got a minute. I'm all yours. *(motions with her hand for Nathan to continue)*

NATHAN: *(flustered, he completely blows it)* So is Arnauld really your boyfriend?

BROOKE: *(Brooke makes a face)* **(pg 39)** [He] says I'm getting fat and need to work out more. *(She turns and looks over her shoulder)* Do you think my *butt* looks too big? That's what Arnauld said.

NATHAN: *(Stammering)* Ah . . no . . . I think your bottom looks great . . . really, really, really . . . great.

BROOKE: See this is why I should be dating someone like you . . . You're so sweet. As for Arnauld, I suppose this is what I get for dating a gym addict. He has such an incredible body, but it makes him expect everyone else to have one too.

NATHAN: *(To audience)* I don't want to hear about Arnauld's incredible body. I wish he were a sloth with a beer belly and . . *(To Brooke)* Does he have hair on his back at least?

BROOKE: No . . he gets it waxed. *(giggling)* He'd look like a monkey if he didn't . . . .

NATHAN: **(Pg 148)** *(To audience)* The entire walk back to my [cubicle] I plot my revenge. The caricature I've got planned will be a pre-waxed Arnold in the Amazon, swinging from a vine with a very small banana.

TRANSITION

ACTRESS: *There are ups and downs, lots of coffee break visits.*
ACTOR: *But despite the annoying Monkey Man lurking in the background, over time their relationship grows . . .*
ACTRESS: *Until, a month later when Arnauld, the illustrious president of Sketch Republic, makes a very public announcement*
ACTOR: *He and Brooke are getting married!*

NATHAN: **(pg 224 – 225)** *(to Audience)* I fire up my computer. My task is very specific. Google Search: How to woo a girl. I find just what I'm looking for on Wiki Answers.

BROOKE: *(off stage as the computer voice)* Show interest . . . look in her eyes when you speak.

NATHAN: Yeah, yeah, yeah

BROOKE: Whisper in her ear

NATHAN: That's weird, but easy. Do they mean all the time? That would be ridiculous

BROOKE: Learn to dance.

NATHAN: Seriously? That has disaster written all over it.

BROOKE: Take the first step. If you're ever going to win the prize you have to tell the prize you want it.

NATHAN: Now that makes sense to me! *(To audiene)* I read the list three times, jotting down ideas on note cards. *(Brooke's voice off stage keeps softly repeating the instructions under Nathan's monolog; Nathan in words and pantomime)* I tape up everything on my bathroom mirror so I can review the suggestions often. *(Nathan picks up his phone and dials – speaking confidently)* Hey Brooke, it's Nathan. I'd like to take you to dinner tonight so we can talk. *(awkward pause, then nervously)* So, um, give me a call . . . okay . . . thanks . . .bye. *(another long pause)* Just to let you know . . . I'm not going to let you marry him.

TRANSITION

ACTOR: *No response from Brooke except for a cryptic text:*
ACTRESS: *(texting) Sorry, can't do dinner, at Arnauld's now.*
ACTOR: *And when she doesn't show up at work the next day, Nathan, of course, gets a little crazy and begins texting Brooke like a drug addict fresh out of rehab . . . .*
ACTRESS: *All. Day. Long.*

NATHAN: *(to audience while Brook pounds relentlessly on his front door)* **(Pg 231-235)** The crazed beating on my front door is the first indication that this won't be a pleasant visit.

BROOKE: What's wrong with you? Have you lost your mind? Why did you call or text me every fifteen minutes today?

NATHAN: But, I needed to talk to you . . .

BROOKE: Right. Got that. But maybe I needed some space and silent support, not more pressure! *(Begins to cry she's so angry)* My boss and quasi-boyfriend announced to the entire company that he was marrying me like I'm some idiot mail order bride. I've been trying to find another job, so I could finally get out from under him. And you! *(She pushes him)* You're the one who's stirred everything

up. You and your damn pedestal, treating me like I'm sooo perfect . . . I'm a mess, Nathan. The sooner you figure [that] out the better off you'll be.

NATHAN: *(crossing his arms and matching her intensity)* [Well,] I'm not going anywhere. . . . Besides, even if you are a mess, you're my perfect mess.

BROOKE: Quit saying that! I'm not perfect Nathan . . . not even close. *(taking a deep breath that shivers from left-over tears they have a moment of eye contact)* Whatever am I going to do with you. *(she smiles)* Thank you . . . I actually feel a little bit better. I'm sorry I yelled at you.

NATHAN: And pushed me . . . I'm not. I think you needed that. We both did.

BROOKE: *(wiping the tears from her cheeks)* Ugh, I'm a mess. Where's the bathroom.

NATHAN: First door on the right. *(Brooke exits) (to himself)* (Pg 234-235) She's been trying to leave Arnold. She wants a new job, she thinks ***she's*** a mess . . . wait Oh, no! *(To audience)* Brooke is in my bathroom . . . where the instructions are posted. *(The bathroom door opens and Brooke steps out with a notecard in her hand and silently hands it to Nathan)*

BROOKE: **(Pg 239-241)** Read it.

NATHAN: *(Embarrassed beyond words)* Today is the day I will tell Brooke that I'm in love with her? *(He can't look up)*

BROOKE: So are you going to tell me?

NATHAN: *(Nathan looks up and says softly)* I'm in love with you, Brooke.

BROOKE: *(Pushes Nathan playfully)* Like you mean it!

NATHAN: *(Nathan shakes off his mortification and drops to one knee, proclaiming loudly)* I'm in love with you, Brooke. Completely, utterly, overwhelmingly in love with you.

BROOKE: **(Pg 371)** *(pause, helping Nathan to his feet)* You know something . . . you animate me, Nathan. It's as if you've brought the real Brooke to life.

NATHAN: The real Brooke just needed someone to believe in her.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ruth Clampett
ISBN: 978-0989391900
Publisher: Clampett Studio Collections
Date (Month/Year): May 2013

AWARD HISTORY

2016 National Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY